



NON-FORMAL EDUCATION SESSION

“European ABC: Educational Workshops for Seniors”

Session 1

“Free Movement of Persons, Goods, Services and Capital”

Author: Guntars Ratenieks

Objective of the session: Reduce Euroscepticism among the senior social group

Sub-objectives of the session:

1. Promote positive examples and benefits of European Union policies
2. Demonstrate the benefits for seniors from the free movement of persons, goods, services, and capital

Description of the target group: Seniors aged 60+

Methods used in the session:

Interactive simulation game with discussion and reflection

Teaching aids: Interactive screen , situation cards, colored notes or voting cards, whiteboard / flipchart . markers

Course of the session:

To explore the audience’s opinions and encourage reflection on the issue, questions are posed. The instructor asks participants to complete the sentence:

“When I hear ‘European Union’, I think of...”

(15 minutes)

As an introduction, to encourage the audience to express critical comments and not to be afraid that opposing opinions are “inappropriate” in relation to the current state policy, a short excerpt from the views of two well-known individuals could be used:

<https://www.lsm.lv/raksts/dzive--stils/cilvekstasti/20.09.2023-ka-veletaji-pirms-20-gadiem-pienema-lemumu-par-vai-pret-latviju-eiropas-savieniba.a524582/>

(15 minutes)

It presents the opinions of two well-known people in the country.

Stimulating questions: Can I travel to any European country without problems? Can I work there?

(5 minutes) The lecturer gains a general understanding of the audience’s views, e.g., by asking for a show of hands from those who think “yes.” The others briefly comment on why not.



Introduction to the main principles underlying the free movement of persons, goods, services, and capital

Presentation (10 minutes)

Which groups benefit from the free movement of goods, services, and capital

Audience activity in pairs, drawing roles (cards with specific roles), for example: student, farmer, etc.

(20 minutes)

Is it good that foreigners can freely invest capital in the country?

Vote: yes / no (if no – discussion)

Presentation includes figures on properties purchased by foreigners, especially forests and agricultural land. Legislation restricting the purchase of agricultural land.

(10 minutes)

Arguments in favor of foreign investment (discussion)

(20 minutes)

Conclusion, feedback: Written responses to short questions

(5–10 minutes)

Appendix: Role-play cards

student – hairdresser

farmer – cook

teacher – senior

doctor – engineer

worker – athlete



Title of the Simulation Game

“Life in Europe: How Do EU Freedoms Help Me?”

Main Objective of the Session

To reduce Euroscepticism among seniors by using practical and personally meaningful examples of the benefits of the European Union’s four freedoms.

Sub-objectives

1. To promote positive examples and benefits of European Union policies
2. To demonstrate the benefits seniors gain from the free movement of persons, goods, services, and capital

Session Structure

1. Introduction (10–15 minutes)

Facilitator’s Introduction

The facilitator briefly introduces the concept of the EU’s “four freedoms”:

- Free movement of persons
- Free movement of goods
- Free movement of services
- Free movement of capital

The facilitator asks the question:

“Do decisions made by the European Union affect our everyday lives even after the age of 60?”

Participants briefly share their opinions.

2. Simulation Game (45–55 minutes)

Game Concept

Participants take on different roles and solve everyday situations in which the EU’s four freedoms are applied.

Game Procedure

Step 1 — Dividing into Groups

Participants are divided into four groups.

Each group receives:



- one situation description,
- role cards,
- a task.

Step 2 — Role-play Situations

Situation No. 1

“Grandchildren Living in Ireland”

Topic:

Free movement of persons

Situation:

Anna is 68 years old. Her daughter works in Ireland, and Anna wants to visit her grandchildren regularly. She uses the European Health Insurance Card, benefits from cheaper flights, and travels across Europe without visas.

Group Task:

Discuss:

- What difficulties would exist without the EU?
- What benefits do seniors gain?
- How do travel opportunities improve quality of life?

Discussion Questions:

- Has it become easier to maintain family connections?
- How do seniors benefit from freedom of movement?

Situation No. 2

“Cheaper Medicines and Safer Products”

Topic:

Free movement of goods

Situation:

Jānis regularly purchases medicines and household goods produced in other EU countries. He notices that products are safer, more affordable, and that there is a wider choice available.



Group Task:

Find examples of:

- How does the EU affect prices and quality?
- What are the benefits for consumers?
- How do EU standards protect people?

Discussion Questions:

- Would goods be more expensive without the Single Market?
- Why is product quality important for seniors?

Situation No. 3

“Pension and Banking in Europe”

Topic:

Free movement of capital

Situation:

Pēteris receives his pension in Latvia, while his son lives in Germany. He can easily transfer money, use his bank card while traveling, and safely make payments in other EU countries.

Group Task:

Evaluate:

- What are the benefits of a unified financial system?
- How do secure banking services help seniors?
- What problems would exist without common rules?

Discussion Questions:

- Do easier payments improve everyday life?
- How does the EU contribute to financial security?

Situation No. 4

“Medical Treatment in Another EU Country”

Topic:



Free movement of services

Situation:

Marija needs eye surgery. She learns that in certain cases, medical treatment can be received in another EU country.

Group Task:

Discuss:

- What benefits do patients receive?
- How does the EU expand access to services?
- How does this improve seniors' quality of life?

Discussion Questions:

- Does access to treatment create a greater sense of security?
- What are the risks and benefits?

3. Presentations and Group Discussion (15–20 minutes)

Each group:

- briefly presents its situation,
- identifies the main benefits for seniors,
- shares one conclusion:

“What do I personally gain from the European Union?”

The facilitator summarizes the responses on a flipchart.

4. Reflection and Conclusion (10 minutes)

Facilitator's Questions

- What surprised me today?
- Did I learn something new?
- Has my attitude toward the EU changed?
- Which EU opportunities do I already use today?

Use of the Interactive Screen



The screen may be used to:

- demonstrate maps and travel routes,
- present examples from EU countries,
- display price comparisons,
- conduct voting (“Is this a benefit?”),
- show short videos or statistics.

Expected Outcomes

After the session, participants:

- better understand the significance of the EU’s four freedoms,
- can identify specific benefits for seniors,
- evaluate negative stereotypes about the EU more critically,
- feel a stronger personal connection to the European Union.